Max I. Kagan

Columbia Business School
Henry R. Kravis Hall, 790 WS 13
665 West 130th Street
New York, NY 10027

mik2124@columbia.edu
www.maxkagan.com

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Columbia Business School
Postdoctoral Research Scholar, Management Division 2024–present

University of Chicago Booth School of Business
Affiliate Fellow, George J. Stigler Center for the Study of the Economy and the State 2026–present

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley
Ph.D., Political Science 2024
M.A., Political Science 2021

Middlebury College
B.A., Political Science 2014

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

[4] Hurst, Reuben⋆, Max Kagan⋆, Matthew Lee⋆, and Justin Frake⋆. "**Organizational Civic Culture: Workplaces and Democratic Participation**." Provisionally accepted at *Administrative Science Quarterly*.

[3] Kagan, Max⋆, Justin Frake⋆, and Reuben Hurst⋆, 2026. "**VRscores: A Voter Registration-Based Approach for Measuring Workforce Politics**." *Organization Science*, 37(2):444–465.

[2] Frake, Justin⋆, Reuben Hurst⋆, and Max Kagan⋆, 2026. "**Political Segregation in the U.S. Workplace**." *Nature Human Behaviour*.

- American Political Science Association Dorothy Day Award for Outstanding Labor Research (2025)
- Media coverage: Niskanen Center, Marginal Revolution

[1] Brutger, Ryan⋆, Stephen Chaudoin⋆, and Max Kagan⋆, 2023. "**Trade Wars and Election Interference.**" *Review of International Organizations*, 18:1–25.

⋆ *denotes equal authorship*

WORKING PAPERS

[4] White, James⋆, Reuben Hurst⋆, and Max Kagan⋆. "**Corporate Political Stances and Employee Turnover**." Revise and resubmit at *Management Science*.

- Strategic Management Society Strategic Human Capital Interest Group Best Paper Prize (2025)
- Strategic Management Society Annual Conference Best Paper Prize *(nominated)* (2025)

[3] Kagan, Max. "**Employees as an Internal Constituency for Corporate Political Strategy**."

[2] Kagan, Max, and Vanessa Burbano. "**Beyond Left and Right: New Evidence on Consumer Reactions to Corporate Sociopolitical Stance-Taking**."
- AOM Annual Meeting Best Paper Designation (2025)

[1] Frake, Justin*, Matthew Lee*, Reuben Hurst*, and Max Kagan. "**Where Americans Work Shapes Whether They Vote: Evidence From 30 Million U.S. Workers**"

* *denotes equal authorship*

EARLIER-STAGE PROJECTS

[3] "Politics of Mutual Fund Managers and Proxy Voting Behavior" (with Luigi Zingales and Jacob Marini)

[2] "Organizational Political Stratification: Extent, Causes, Effects" (with JT Gartner, Justin Frake, and Reuben Hurst)

[1] Measuring Virtue: A Field Experiment on Motivations Behind Corporate Social Responsibility (with Daniel Nielson)

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Fellowships

- National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program (NSF GRFP) #2146752, 2021–2024 — $141,000
- Law, Economics, and Policy (LEAP) Center, Berkeley Law, 2022–2023 — $9,000

Grants

- University of Michigan "U.S. at 250" Grant, 2026 (with Justin Frake) — $5,000
- University of Michigan "Year of Democracy" Grant, 2025 (with Justin Frake) — $5,000
- Faculty Research Grant, Bernstein Center for Leadership and Ethics Columbia Business School, 2024–2025 (with Vanessa Burbano) — $10,000
- Berkeley Economy and Society Initiative (Hewlett Foundation), 2024 — $2,500
- Berkeley Graduate Division Travel Grant, 2024 — $1,500
- Berkeley Graduate Division Travel Grant, 2024 — $900
- Berkeley Economy and Society Initiative (Hewlett Foundation), 2023 — $4,600
- Berkeley Center for the Study of American Democracy (CSAD), 2023 — $2,500
- Berkeley Network for a New Political Economy (N2PE), 2022 — $2,000
- American Political Science Association (APSA) Travel Grant, 2021 — $300
- Berkeley Political Science Departmental Award, 2021 — $2,600

INVITED TALKS

2026

- Civic Summit *(featured research presentation at Civic Alliance summit)*
- IE University (Strategy)

2025
- Michigan Ross (Strategy)
- Rice (Organizational Behavior)
- University of Texas at Austin (Business, Government, and Society)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026
- Academy of Management (Philadelphia)
- Berkeley Culture Connect Conference
- Oxford University Saïd Business School Centre for Corporate Reputation Symposium
- Stigler Center Affiliate Fellows Conference (University of Chicago Booth)
- Sumantra Ghoshal Strategy Conference (London Business School)

2025
- Academy of Management (Copenhagen)
- Alliance for Research on Corporate Sustainability (HEC Paris)
- Columbia–Cornell Political Economy of Work Junior Scholars Workshop (Columbia)
- Non-Market Strategy Research Consortium Doctoral Conference (virtual)
- People & Organizations Conference (Wharton)
- Strategic Management Society (San Francisco)
- Strategy and the Business Environment (Wharton)

2024
- Academy of Management (Chicago)
- Bay Area Affective Polarization Workshop (Stanford)
- Consortium on the American Political Economy (virtual)
- Copenhagen Business School–Princeton Money in Politics Conference (Copenhagen)
- Midwest Political Science Association (Chicago)
- Non-Market Strategy Research Consortium Doctoral Conference (virtual)
- Polarization Research Lab Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA)
- Stanford-Berkeley American Politics Conference (Stanford GSB)
- Strategic Management Society Special Conference (Washington, D.C.)

2023
- American Political Science Association (Los Angeles)
- Conference on Field Experiments in Strategy (CFXS) (Harvard Business School)
- Junior Americanist Workshop Series (JAWS) MPSA Pre-Conference (Chicago)
- Midwest Political Science Association (Chicago)

2021
- American Political Science Association (Seattle)
- Graduate Student International Political Economy (GSIPE) (virtual)

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **Strategic Management Society**: Research Methods Paper Prize *(nominated)* 2026

- **Strategic Management Society**: Strategic Human Capital Interest Group Best Paper Prize 2025
- **Strategic Management Society**: Best Paper Prize *(nominated)* 2025
- **Academy of Management**: Best Paper Designation 2025
- **American Political Science Assoc.**: Dorothy Day Award for Outstanding Labor Research 2025
- **University of California, Berkeley**: Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award 2022
- **Phi Beta Kappa** 2014

SERVICE TO THE DISCIPLINE

Journal Reviewer

- Management: *Administrative Science Quarterly, Management Science, Organization Science, Strategic Management Journal*
- Political Science: *Business and Politics, Journal of Politics, Review of International Organizations*

Organizer

- "Workplace Sorting by Political Partisanship" Symposium, AOM 2024, 2025

Invited Participation

- "Cross-Pollinating Corporate Political Activity (CPA): The Future of the Field" Academy of Management *(panelist)* 2026
- "New Theoretical and Empirical Research Opportunities from Examining Career Histories (Revelio PDW)," Academy of Management *(invited discussant)* 2026
- Consortium on the American Political Economy–Junior Working Group *(invited discussant)* 2025
- "Macro and Micro Perspectives on Political Ideology and Partisanship in Organizations," Academy of Management *(panelist)* 2025
- "Research Frontiers in Nonmarket Strategy," Academy of Management *(invited discussant)* 2025

Committee Service

- Dorothy Day Award Committee, American Political Science Assoc. Labor Politics Group 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, Berkeley

- The Politics of Public Policy (undergraduate; TA for David Broockman)
- International Political Economy (undergraduate; TA for Ryan Brutger)
- War in the Middle East (undergraduate; TA for Ron Hassner)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Good Jobs Institute, Cambridge, MA
Associate 2018–19
Non-profit consultancy that helps companies thrive by creating good jobs.

Long Ridge Equity Partners, New York City
Associate 2017–18
Growth equity firm investing in financial and business technology companies.

McKinsey & Company

Senior Business Analyst 2016–17
Private Equity & Principal Investors Practice, New York City

Business Analyst 2014–16
Middle East Office, Dubai

Served clients in banking, telecommunications, and the public sector across Saudi Arabia, Qatar, and the United States; conducted market due diligence for private equity firms.

REFERENCES

Vanessa C. Burbano
Donald C. Waite III Associate Professor of Social Enterprise
Columbia Business School
Henry R. Kravis Hall
665 West 130th Street
New York, NY 10027
vanessa.burbano@gsb.columbia.edu

Justin Frake
Assistant Professor of Strategy
Ross School of Business
University of Michigan
701 Tappan Street, R4442
Ann Arbor, MI 48109
jfrake@michigan.edu

Brayden King
Max McGraw Chair in Management and the Environment
Kellogg School of Management
2211 Campus Drive
Evanston, IL 60208
b-king@kellogg.northwestern.edu

Matthew Lee
Associate Professor of Public Policy and Management
Harvard Kennedy School
79 John F. Kennedy Street
Cambridge, MA 02138
matthew_lee@hks.harvard.edu

David Broockman
Associate Professor of Political Science
University of California, Berkeley
784 Social Sciences Building
Berkeley, CA 94720
dbroockman@berkeley.edu